Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

The Elms

The Elms, Heol Y Capel, Llanelli, SA14 7EW

01792 885126

https://mdcareltd.co.uk

Date(s) of inspection visit(s): The inspection visit took place on 25/09/2025

Service Information:

Operated by:	M&D Care Operations Ltd
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability, Provision for mental health
Registered places:	9
Main language(s):	Welsh and English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The service provider is not meeting the Welsh language and culture needs of people and this requires improvement.

Ratings:

Well-being	Excellent
Care & Support	Excellent
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Excellent

Summary:

The Elms is a residential care home in Foelgastell, providing care and support for up to nine people.

The service excels in promoting well-being, delivering personalised care and support, maintaining a safe and welcoming environment, and exemplary leadership and management. People experience excellent wellbeing outcomes because the support they receive helps them to live well and maintain and improve upon their physical and mental health. Care staff understand what is important to people and anticipate their needs and wishes exceedingly well. People engage in a wide variety of meaningful activities to enhance their well-being. People receive excellent care and support at The Elms. Care staff know people very well and provide care in a kind and caring manner. People live in a good environment and benefit from a warm, comfortable, welcoming home, which meets their needs. The provider undertakes regular maintenance and repairs, and ensures the environment is safe. The leadership and management of the service is excellent. The service is very well-led and has an extremely positive culture of promoting the well-being of both the people it supports, and its staff.

Findings:

Well-being — Excellent

People's right to make their own choices is promoted by the positive culture in the service. We saw care staff asking people questions and encouraging them to make choices where they could. Care workers offer a choice of high-quality meals, and the service has a food hygiene rating of five, which is 'very good'. Monthly 'My Voice' meetings take place with the person supported and their keyworker. People can have a say in the running of the home. Daily records show care staff work exceptionally hard to make sure people's personal outcomes are met. A health professional said, "*They 100% put people's needs first*".

People are supported to do things they enjoy, which keep them happy and healthy, and provide a sense of personal well-being. They are supported to maintain their physical and mental health, and emotional well-being. People are offered choices in daily activities and have opportunities to reach their potential. People engage in activities that are meaningful to them, such as choosing meals, visiting family, engaging in hobbies and accessing facilities in the community. We saw many excellent examples where the support people have received has enabled them to achieve huge personal goals. For some we saw a reduction in medication, a reduction in the level of 1:1 support being required, and a Deprivation of Liberty Safeguard no longer being needed.

People are protected from abuse and neglect. Care staff are recruited in line with regulation to ensure they are suitable to work with vulnerable people. Care staff are trained to meet the needs of those they support and demonstrate a clear understanding of their safeguarding responsibilities. Detailed policies and procedures, aligned with best practice and statutory guidance, underpin safe and effective care. Risk assessments highlighting areas of concern are completed and regularly reviewed. There are measures in place to ensure medication is safely stored and administered.

People live in accommodation that supports their well-being. The environment at The Elms meets the needs of the people living there. Bedrooms are comfortable and personalised, with most having a good-sized living area and all having ensuite showering facilities. There are sufficient communal areas available. The home is clean and well-maintained, with the correct checks and servicing in place for utilities and equipment. There is an ongoing refurbishment programme in place.

Care & Support — Excellent

People receive an excellent standard of care at The Elms. We saw people are supported in a kind and patient manner, with care being delivered in a calm and respectful way. The service carries out a thorough assessment prior to a person moving to the home to ensure they can meet their needs and to consider the impact for other people at the service. Personal plans are highly effective, reflect individual needs and give the information needed to support people well. Comprehensive risk assessments are in place to ensure people are supported to make their own choices as much as possible and remain safe. All documents are kept under review and updated regularly to ensure they remain accurate and reflective. People are actively involved in both the planning and review processes and are routinely consulted about the wider service. A range of formal and informal opportunities are available for people to express their views. Feedback from a social worker stated, "*In summary, The Elms has provided outstanding, compassionate care that has made a profound difference in this gentleman's life*".

People are referred for appropriate care and treatment at the right time. People's health needs are clearly documented in personal plans. People have timely access to health and social care professionals, and advice is sought promptly when required. Highly effective systems are in place to ensure medication is managed well. Secure arrangements are in place for ordering and administering medication, which is stored securely. Medication administration record (MAR) charts contain all required information and are completed correctly with signatures when medication has been administered. The medication policy in place contains guidance on the administration of 'as required' medication (PRN). We saw evidence staff receive training on the administration of medication to ensure they remain sufficiently skilled. The completion of routine medication audits ensures practice remains safe and effective.

People are kept safe from harm and abuse, ensuring all legal requirements are met. Risks are identified and robust risk management plans are reviewed regularly to ensure risks are minimised. If concerns are raised or identified these are taken seriously and fully investigated. People are encouraged to take positive risks, such as being supported to manage their own medication and access the community independently. Care staff have completed up to date safeguarding training, and there is a robust safeguarding policy in place to underpin good practice. The staff we spoke with all confirmed they understand their safeguarding responsibilities and would be confident to raise any concerns. Best interest decisions are made for people who may not have capacity to make specific decisions, following consultation with other professionals.

Environment

Good

The environment is homely, clean and comfortable, and suited to people's needs. There are communal areas which are well used. We saw people relaxing, eating and engaging with others. People were at ease with each other and staff and were relaxed and happy. We saw people who are able to choose where to spend their time going from their rooms to communal areas as they wish.

The service demonstrates a strong commitment to ensuring the premises and any equipment is maintained and serviced to a good standard. We saw there is routine servicing of utilities such as electricity and gas which is carried out by external contractors. Effective and efficient fire procedures, testing, and training are in place to protect people. Records confirmed fire alarm tests take place regularly and an up-to-date fire risk assessment is in place. Every individual living at the home has a personal emergency evacuation plan specific to their support needs, and staff undertake routine fire drills.

Security arrangements are in place to protect people. The home is secure to prevent unauthorised access. Visitors make themselves known on arrival and staff ensure they sign in and out of the premises.

People are protected by high standards of hygiene practices which comply with laws and guidelines related to food handling, hand washing, and cleaning. Highly effective daily cleaning schedules are in place as all parts of the home are clean, tidy and well organised. During the inspection we saw a plentiful supply of personal protective equipment (PPE) is available to staff. Care staff were wearing appropriate PPE when required. Substances hazardous to health (COSSH) are stored appropriately and securely. We saw the laundry facilities, which are more than suitable to meet the needs of people living in the home. A current detailed policy on infection control measures is in place, it is reviewed and updated as necessary.

Leadership & Management — Excellent

People achieve excellent outcomes because the provider has a very strong commitment to ensuring good numbers of skilled and knowledgeable staff are always in the service. They recruit staff safely and provide them with consistent support to ensure people receive a good standard of quality care. New care staff receive a thorough and effective induction that includes shadow shifts, and this was confirmed by care staff we spoke to, who spoke positively about their experiences of working in the home. We saw effective vetting checks for new staff, and Disclosure Barring Service (DBS) checks for all staff are renewed in a timely way. Care staff are registered with Social Care Wales (SCW) the work force regulator. Records show staff receive regular, effective one to one supervision as well as annual appraisals of their performance. The management team ensure all staff undertake the training required. Training is monitored by the manager and consistently meets the needs of people living in the home. A care worker told us "*I do enjoy this job*". The rota showed appropriate staffing levels are achieved and was reflective on the day. The service does not use agency staff; this ensures continuity of care for individuals. We saw staff follow robust company policies and procedures, which supports good outcomes for people.

The service is extremely well-led, with organisational arrangements, governance and oversight in place to help the service run smoothly. The service has an exceedingly positive culture of promoting the well-being of both the people it supports and its staff. The provider uses comprehensive audits of all aspects of the service to monitor practices. Highly effective governance arrangements and strong leadership ensure good quality care and support for people. We saw evidence that the Responsible Individual (RI) has good oversight of the service. We looked at documentation, which confirmed formal quarterly visits take place. The service appropriately notifies relevant regulatory bodies and statutory agencies when there are concerns or significant events that might affect the well-being of individuals receiving care. A dedicated and experienced manager ensures people are at the heart of the smoothly run service. The service has a strong vision and ethos. Its aims, values, and delivery of support are set out in the statement of purpose in a transparent way. A written guide is available for people in the service, containing practical information about the service, and the support provided. The service also offers a very good variety of formal and informal opportunities for people and their representatives, to ask questions and give feedback. The manager has an 'open door' policy and is very approachable, care staff confirmed this.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Mae’r adroddiad hwn hefyd ar gael yn Gymraeg

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